AI GOVERNANCE IN PRACTICE

One high-risk AI system, start to finish

How a new AI use moves from idea to live service, without anyone being asked the same thing twice.

Illustrative example · Proposed design, for Council confirmation

PROPORTIONATE BY DESIGN

Low risk takes the fast lane

Example: staff using the Council's already-approved AI assistant to summarise their own meeting notes.

1 · Ten quick questions

One page. All ten No, so it is eligible.

2 · Lead confirms and registers

A light register entry. Equality, rights and privacy checked by reference to existing assessments.

3 · One decision, then go

Recorded before use. Checked once a year.

	Fast lane	High-risk case
Screening	Ten yes/no questions	Full intake and triage
Rating	Low · Priority 4 or 5	High · Priority 2
Evidence	Existing assessments, by reference	16 items, sized to the risk
Decision	One delegated decision	One paper, with the Board's opinion
Monitoring	Annual check	Monthly, and quarterly to the Board

Any Yes or Unsure, or a material change, moves it to the full route. The fast lane never skips equality, human rights or data protection duties.

THE EXAMPLE

A damp and mould urgency tool

A new tool scores damp and mould reports and recommends an urgency band. **A housing officer confirms every band.**

Why it counts as high risk: it affects vulnerable residents, which is a mandatory escalation trigger, so the Lead and the AI Assurance Board are told straight away.

WHAT TRIAGE WORKED OUT

Priority 2 · High

How quickly governance looks at it

High risk tier

Sets the route and the decision-maker

16 evidence items

Sized to this risk, not a fixed checklist

Results from the live triage tool for this illustrative case.

THE JOURNEY

Six steps, one record

Before deployment | After pilot | Ongoing

1

Tell us once

Service Owner

One intake form. Never asked again.

2

Triage

AI Governance Lead

Priority, risk and route worked out.

3

Checks

Specialists

Only the checks this case needs, side by side.

4

Decide

Delegated forum

One paper. The Board advises; the forum decides.

5

Go live

Service Owner

Pilot evidence shown; conditions met first.

6

Monitor

Service Owner

Monthly review; quarterly to the Board.

One AIR-ID throughout Every answer, check, decision and condition sits on one record that travels to each forum.

WHO DOES WHAT

Everyone does their part once

Role	Does	No longer has to
Service Owner	Tells us once; confirms the case; runs monitoring	Re-brief each board, or work out which checks apply
AI Governance Lead	Triage, routing, the decision paper and the record	Chase history across boards; it is already on the record
Specialists	Only the checks this case triggers (DPIA, equality, human rights, security)	Ask again what intake already captured
AI Assurance Board	One assurance opinion every forum can rely on	Approve; authority stays with the delegated forum
Decision-maker	Decides, with conditions, from one paper	Piece the story together from separate boards

AFTER GO-LIVE

Watching it, and acting fast

What we watch, for example

- How often officers change the suggested band
- Whether accuracy holds across groups of residents
- Complaints and challenges to an outcome

Monthly performance review; quarterly formal review to the AI Assurance Board.

If something goes wrong

1. The Service Owner pauses it straight away
2. The Lead and the Board are told
3. The delegated forum decides what happens next

Logged on the same record, so the history is never lost.

Measures shown are examples for this case; each system's monitoring plan sets its own.

Govern by exception, not by archaeology.

Every answer, check, decision and condition sits on one record, so nobody has to dig back through separate boards to find out what happened.

Proposed design, for Council confirmation

THE LEGAL BASIS

Grounded in law, guidance and standards

AI law and policy

EU AI Act · ICO statutory code on AI and automated decisions (SI 2026/425) · UK Government AI Playbook · ATRS

Data protection

UK GDPR · Data Protection Act 2018 · Data (Use and Access) Act 2025 · ICO guidance on AI

Fairness and rights

Equality Act 2010 and the Public Sector Equality Duty · Human Rights Act 1998 · EHRC guidance on AI

Council governance

Local Government Act 1972 (s101 delegation) · Best Value Duty · FOI and the Transparency Code

Security and safety

NCSC secure AI guidelines · AI Cyber Security Code of Practice · Civil Contingencies Act 2004

International standards

ISO/IEC 42001, 23894 and 42005 · NIST AI 600-1 generative AI profile · ISO/IEC 5259 data quality · DAMA-DMBOK

All 58 requirements, each linked to its official source

kimabercromby.github.io/AIGovernanceSuiteTools/regulations.html